

COMPARISON · LEDGER · PROSE

# compare-table

Multi-row comparison table with consistent columns.

# Where the four substance contracts come from.

| SUBSTANCE        | AUTHOR WRITES                   | RENDERER                       | OUTPUT |
|------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------|
| <b>prose</b>     | headings, paragraphs, lists     | Marp markdown → semantic HTML  | DOM    |
| <b>structure</b> | nested lists with conventions   | lib/*.js post-processor        | DOM    |
| <b>series</b>    | tabular DSL (axes + datapoints) | chart-family kernel            | SVG    |
| <b>graph</b>     | external graph language         | external CLI (mmdc, future d2) | SVG    |

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# When NOT to reach for compare-table.

**Cells full of prose.** Long sentences in a table cell wrap awkwardly and force the column wider. Move to `verdict-grid` for criteria with body text, or `cards-stack` for full prose rows.

**More than 6 rows.** Past 6 rows the table density crowds the slide. Split into two slides or summarise the rows that don't differentiate.

**State-marker rows.** When most cells are pass/fail/partial badges, the right layout is `obligation-matrix` or `verdict-grid`. `compare-table` is for textual values.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

`compare-prose` — exactly two options with prose bodies

`verdict-grid` — options scored against criteria with pass/partial/fail badges

`obligation-matrix` — many regimes compared against shared obligations

`cards-stack` — each row needs full-prose breathing room rather than a tabular cell